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Due Jul 27 11:59pm Available from Jul 21 until Jul 27 3 points possible

7 Replies

The Film Industry

Discussion

Brainwashed: Sex-Camera-Power **(Nina Menkes, 2022)**

Initial post is DUE by [Sunday 7/27 at 11:59pm]. Reply post(s) DUE by [Sunday 7/27 at 11:59pm].

Purpose

This Module covers several aspects of the film industry including technology, stages of production (preproduction/production/postproduction), the studio system and its decline, the independent system, marketing, distribution, and exhibition. Our discussion will focus on how the formal, financial, and labor

structures of Hollywood have excluded and/or exploited women over the last century. Nina Menkes's *Brainwashed: Sex-Camera-Power* presents convincing evidence from over 100 films to show us *how* women have been shot in Hollywood films in a particular way that perpetuates what Laura Mulvey calls the 'male gaze'.

Instructions

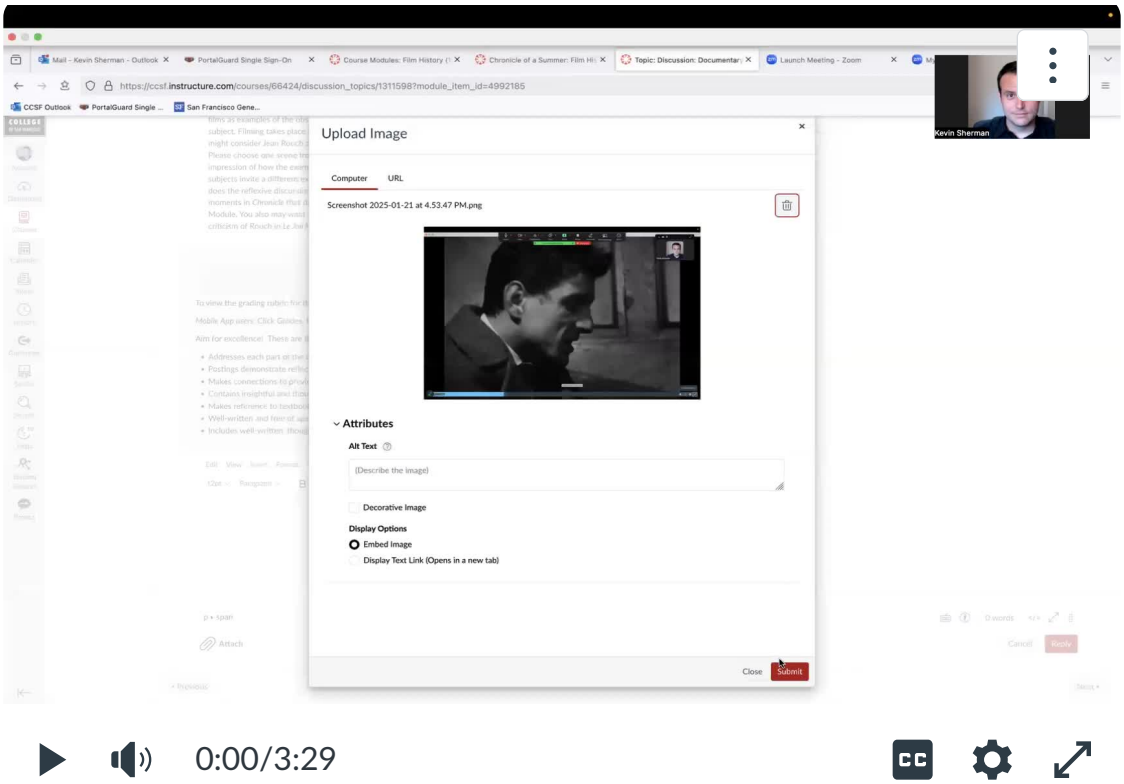
For your **Initial Discussion Post** due by Sunday 7/27 at 11:59pm, please respond to the following prompt below in a post of at least 300 words. You do not have to address every detail of the prompt, but your post should contribute to the discussion and not merely repeat what has already been posted by your classmates. While I encourage you to offer your personal views of the films in this Module, **please refrain from unproductive summaries of story or plot and/or why a film is "good" or "bad."** Assume that everyone in the discussion group has completed the viewing assignment and understands the story/plot of the film. I suggest that you draft your post in Word first and assume that something may go wrong in Canvas when you hit 'Post Reply.' I will not count summary of plot/story or information that is not relevant to the prompt/analysis of one scene toward the required 300-word count. **Please identify the time 0(hr):00(min):00(sec) in the film** where the scene you are analyzing begins and concludes from the stream of the film included in the Module. Please do not repost the questions from this prompt into your post.

Your analysis should refer to course materials and reflect on how film style and history function. A post that earns full points will not merely agree with course materials, but will visually illustrate ideas through personal observation. **Do not forget to include embedded media that visualizes the example(s) in your post.** Please make sure that you read all of the posts in your discussion group before posting. I cannot give full points to posts that analyze scenes or shots that have already been selected by another classmate. Please limit your posts to no more than 400 words and 1-2 examples to give others a chance to write about key scenes/shots. **Please resize your screenshots and images to 'Extra Large' in the 'Image Options.'** The 'Image Options' tag appears above or below an image when you click on it while editing in the Rich Content Editor.

Grading Rubric Checklist for Full Points (Initial Post):

- Post identifies the time where the scene you are analyzing begins and concludes from the stream of the film included in the Module.
- **Post analyzes no less than one minute and no more than three minutes of one scene.** If you wish to discuss another scene, please do so in your response to another classmate.
- Post addresses materials related to the prompt and course materials.
- Post includes at least two embedded screen captures from the scene you are analyzing. **Please resize your screenshots and images to 'Extra Large' in the 'Image Options.'** The 'Image Options' tag appears above or below an image when you click on it while editing in the Rich Content Editor.
- Post does not analyze a scene previously selected by a classmate earlier in the thread. Sometimes a classmate will post about the scene you are analyzing while you are writing. It happens. Just message me and let me know.
- Post includes a YouTube clip not presented in the film that demonstrates one of the ideas from Menkes's "list."

Please Resize Your Screen Captures to 'Extra Large'



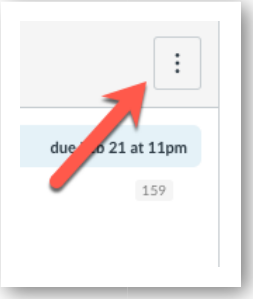
For your **Response Post** to one classmate due by Sunday 7/27 at 11:59pm,

please reply in 75 words or more to at least one classmate's post. Responses may include describing your own insight related to the post, providing additional information from assigned or outside content, disagreeing respectfully by describing your own interpretation, proposing a new idea, or asking a question. I cannot give full points to posts that merely "like" or agree with another post; the response post must demonstrate substantial effort. Please try to respond to a classmate who has not yet received a response.

- Please let the class know what you think about the evidence and ideas presented in *Brainwashed: Sex-Camera-Power*. Has the film changed your thinking about how women are represented in Hollywood films? Please choose one specific example from the documentary **embed at least two (2) screenshots** from the scene into your post. Tell us why the example interests you (i.e. an idea presented by Menkes or other filmmakers, a clip that Menkes presents in the film).
- Please choose a YouTube clip of a film **NOT** presented in the film that demonstrates **one** of the ideas from Menkes's "list" and embed the clip into your post. 1. How does your example present women as either **subject/object**? 2. How does the **framing** of women in your example demonstrate the ideas presented by Menkes? 3. How does **camera movement** show women in your example? How does camera movement support the ideas presented by Menkes? 4. How does **lighting** of women in your example demonstrate the ideas presented by Menkes? 5. How does form communicate the **narrative position** of women in your example? You need only to concentrate on one of these aspects when writing about your example.

Discussion Rubric

To view the grading rubric for this discussion, click on the "more options" icon (3 vertical dots at the top) and then select "show rubric".



Mobile App users: Click Grades, then click into the Discussion. The rubric can then be found on the Grades tab.

Aim for excellence! These are the criteria for what comprises an "Excellent" rating for a discussion post: